

DUAL-CORE OPTICAL MOTION TESTBED

FIRMWARE, HOST SOFTWARE & RESULTS

STM32H747 dual-core motion control, live telemetry, automated test execution, and measured characterization

ENGINEERING REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT | REVISION 5.2 | 5 AUGUST 2026

Prepared by	Herder Elektronische Systemen
Document scope	Dual-core firmware, IPC, host GUI, telemetry integrity, safeguards, and measured motion performance
Evidence basis	MotionIPC source, target firmware, GUI recordings, plots, logs, test scripts, and engineering reviews
Distribution	Customer-facing; controlled source excerpts and engineering evidence
DOCUMENT PURPOSE Defines the controlled functional, performance, interface, safety, verification, and acceptance requirements for the dual-core target firmware and host-side test system. Mechanical construction and PCB manufacturing details are referenced to the companion platform document.	

Requirements Basis

Requirements Definition and Verification

Requirements are uniquely identified and paired with rationale, interfaces, constraints, verification methods, and acceptance evidence. Demonstrated prototype performance is distinguished from unverified, unrated, or future production capability.

Purpose, Scope, and System Boundary

This FRD governs the dual-core target firmware, interprocessor communication, host application, telemetry, automated test execution, data retention, safeguards, and measured motion-performance reporting. The mechanical structure and interface PCB are external interfaces documented in the companion platform FRD.

Boundary element	Included in this FRD	Excluded / referenced
Target firmware	M7/M4 workload allocation, motion sequencing, timing, IPC, heartbeat, fault state	Mechanical fabrication and PCB manufacturing details
Host software	Connection control, commands, live plots, test automation, CSV and metadata	General-purpose IT infrastructure and cloud services
Verification	Low-speed tracking, constant-speed, step response, sine-response, integrity counters	Formal environmental, EMC, safety, or optical-system certification

Users and Operational Scenarios

Actor	Primary interaction	Expected outcome
Operator	Connect, configure, command, monitor, stop, and save a test	Controlled motion with visible state and retained evidence
Firmware developer	Build, deploy, inspect IPC and timing behavior	Traceable target revision and diagnosable inter-core operation
Test engineer	Select scripted characterization and review outputs	Repeatable datasets suitable for comparison and analysis
Reviewer/customer	Read requirements, figures, limits, and verification results	Clear distinction between demonstrated capability and open release actions

Functional Requirements

ID	The system shall...	Rationale / explanation	Verification
FW-FR-001	separate pulse-critical motion control from variable-latency communication and telemetry workloads while retaining the finest tested microstep setting.	At 256 microsteps, required STEP frequency reaches tens of kilohertz as table speed increases. Workload separation protects pulse regularity and control timing.	Architecture review; pulse-rate calculation; high-speed timing test
FW-FR-002	publish motion records with sequence and integrity	Sequence, overflow, and heartbeat fields make loss or	Memory-map review; counter observation

ID	The system shall...	Rationale / explanation	Verification
	information through shared memory.	stalling observable.	
FW-FR-003	accept operator motion commands and expose commanded and measured state in the host GUI.	The operator needs direct confirmation that target behavior follows the requested profile.	GUI demonstration; captured telemetry plots
FW-FR-004	execute repeatable low-speed, constant-speed, step, and sine-response tests.	Scripted tests reduce operator variation and preserve comparable datasets.	Test selection and completed result files
FW-FR-005	record CSV telemetry and run metadata sufficient to reproduce the analysis context.	Plots must remain traceable to commands, timestamps, configuration, and source data.	CSV/header inspection; metadata review
FW-FR-006	limit pulse generation and bound catch-up behavior.	A delayed software loop must not produce an uncontrolled pulse burst.	Source inspection; stress test
FW-FR-007	detect missing host presence and expose target heartbeat, fault, sequence-gap, and drop state.	Communication silence must be distinguishable from normal idle operation.	Fault-injection and disconnect test
FW-FR-008	preserve a safe stop path independent of normal scripted completion.	The operator must be able to terminate motion when a test or communication path behaves unexpectedly.	Stop-command and deadman test

Performance and Quality Requirements

ID	Requirement	Acceptance basis
FW-NFR-001	The reviewed release shall enforce its declared STEP-rate ceiling and document the higher-rate target needed to reach the full 15 deg/s objective at 256 microsteps.	Source constant, pulse-rate calculation, and logic-analyzer timing evidence.
FW-NFR-002	STEP high time shall be at least 4 microseconds.	Logic trace or source review confirms the minimum.
FW-NFR-003	Host-presence timeout shall stop or inhibit continued commanded operation after 2 seconds without heartbeat.	Disconnect test produces the defined safe response.
FW-NFR-004	Telemetry-rate selections shall be explicit and the sustainable serial rate shall not be overstated.	10/20/50/100 Hz options are visible; report distinguishes configured from demonstrated throughput.
FW-NFR-005	Shared-memory records shall maintain cache-safe alignment and bounded service behavior.	64-byte alignment and 128-record service bound confirmed in source.
FW-NFR-006	Reported performance shall identify test conditions, limits, and unsupported claims.	Result sections state the demonstrated range and avoid unsupported bandwidth or certification claims.

External Interface Requirements

Interface	Required behavior	Failure / boundary condition
STEP/DIR output	Generate direction state and bounded step pulses for the motor driver.	Rate cap, minimum high time, and safe stop remain enforced.
Differential encoder input	Receive conditioned encoder position/count information from the interface PCB.	Missing or implausible motion shall be visible in measured-state telemetry.
Host serial link	Transport commands, status, telemetry, and heartbeat.	Loss of heartbeat invokes the defined timeout behavior.
OpenAMP/RPMsg	Carry low-rate command and status messages between cores.	Endpoint or message failure is reported rather than silently ignored.
AXI-SRAM ring	Carry aligned high-rate records with producer/consumer accounting.	Overflow, dropped records, and sequence gaps remain observable.

1. System Role and Delivered Capability

The system combines a dual-core STM32H747 target with a host application that commands motion, displays live encoder and speed telemetry, executes repeatable tests, and writes analysis-ready records. The public evidence package separates control-plane messaging from high-rate motion-data movement and preserves the distinction between demonstrated behavior and recommended release actions.

- Cortex-M7 and Cortex-M4 workloads connected through OpenAMP/RPMsg and a custom AXI-SRAM shared ring.
- Live host console for connection, scripted test selection, telemetry plots, CSV logging, and metadata capture.
- Measured low-speed tracking, constant-speed error, step response, and closed-loop frequency-response evidence.
- Fault, heartbeat, sequence-gap, dropped-record, and ring-status observability.

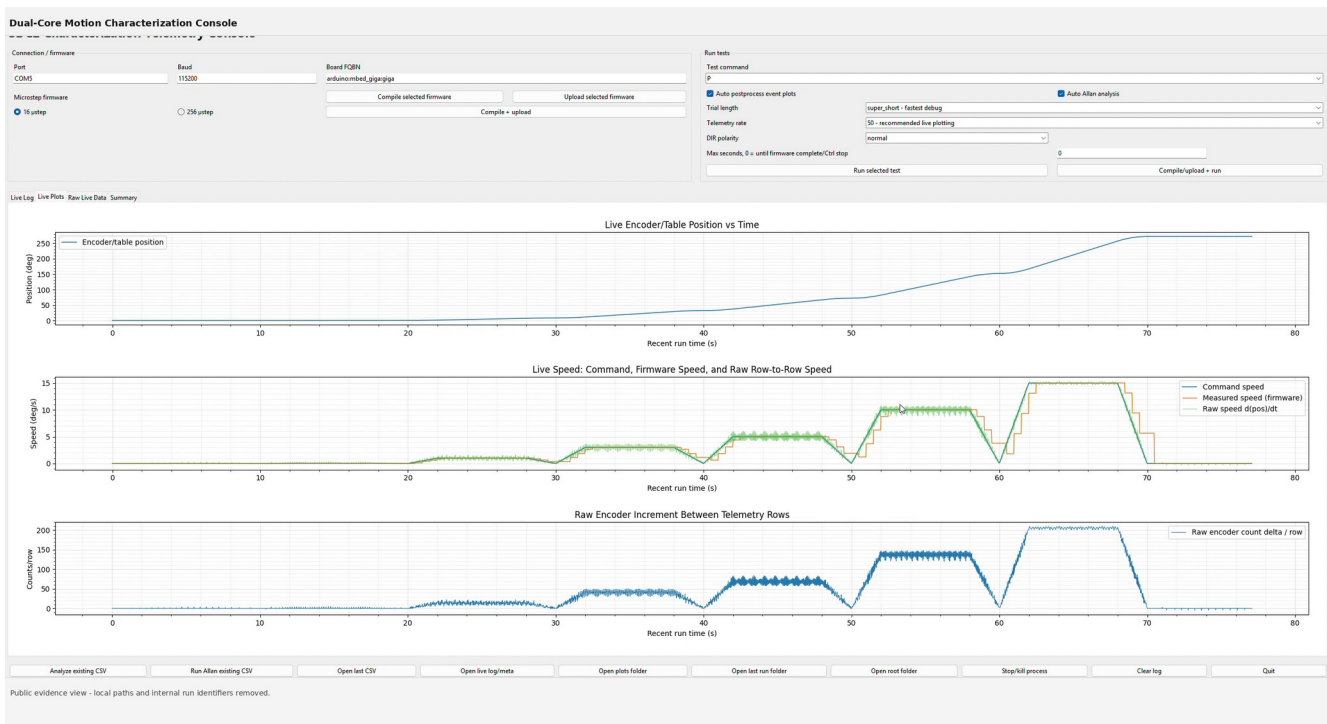
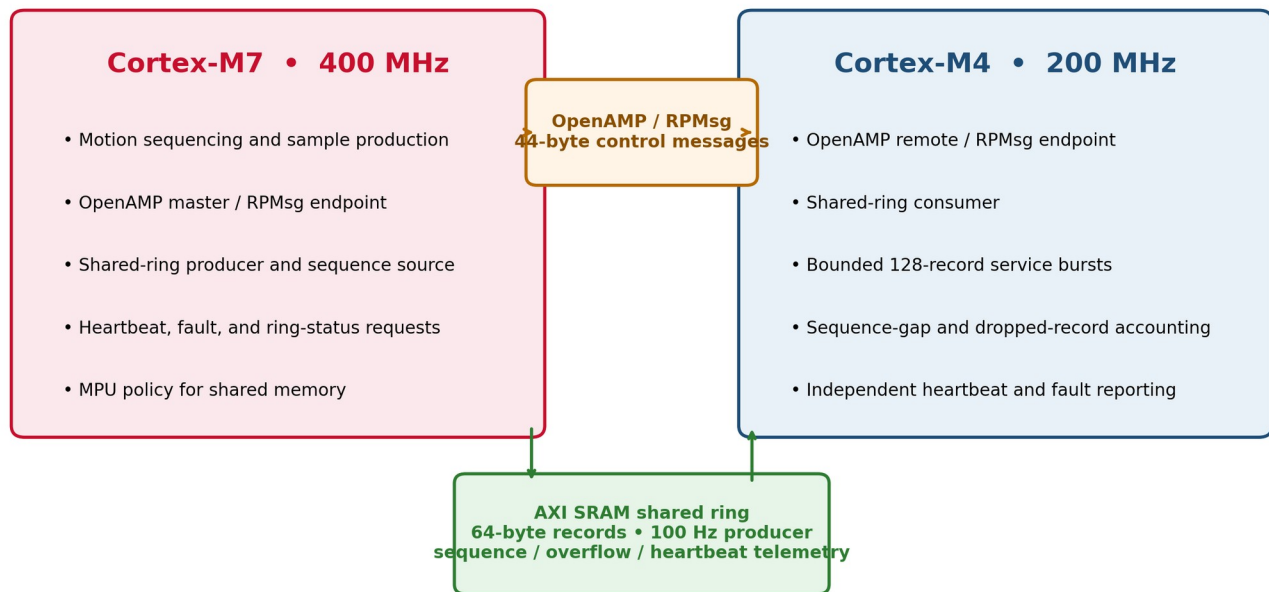


Figure 1. Live host telemetry console during an automated characterization sequence.

2. Dual-Core Firmware Architecture



2.1 Architecture Trade-Off Decision

The dual-core architecture was selected to preserve smooth motion at higher table speeds while retaining the finest tested microstep setting. The design objective was not to accommodate the reviewed 100 Hz, 6.4 kB/s telemetry stream; that workload is trivial for a 400 MHz Cortex-M7. The limiting concern was the STEP pulse frequency required when the driver is configured for the smallest angular increment (256 microsteps per full step).

At 200 full steps per motor revolution, 256 microsteps per full step, and a 24.65:1 gearbox, the drivetrain requires 1,262,080 STEP pulses per table revolution, or approximately 3,505.78 pulses per output degree. Pulse demand therefore rises directly with commanded table speed. At 15 deg/s, the required rate is approximately 52.6 kHz. Moving host communication, telemetry handling, and other variable-latency work to the second core protects the motion-control execution budget and reduces pulse-spacing jitter, missed scheduling opportunities, and speed ripple.

Commanded table speed	Required STEP frequency at 256 microsteps	Decision significance
0.1 deg/s	350.6 Hz	Low pulse demand; either architecture is adequate.
1 deg/s	3.51 kHz	Still modest, but pulse regularity begins to matter for smoothness.
5 deg/s	17.53 kHz	Variable-latency communications and formatting should not share the pulse-critical path.
7.13 deg/s	approximately 25 kHz	Matches the reviewed software safety ceiling.
15 deg/s	approximately 52.6 kHz	Target capability requires a higher pulse-rate implementation while preserving fine microstepping.

OpenAMP/RPMsg and the AXI-SRAM ring are supporting mechanisms for that workload split. They provide command/status exchange and continuous record transfer after the control and host-facing responsibilities are separated. They are not presented as necessary for 100 Hz telemetry, and the present 100 Hz MotionIPC sample should be treated as an architectural validation workload rather than the performance justification for using both cores.

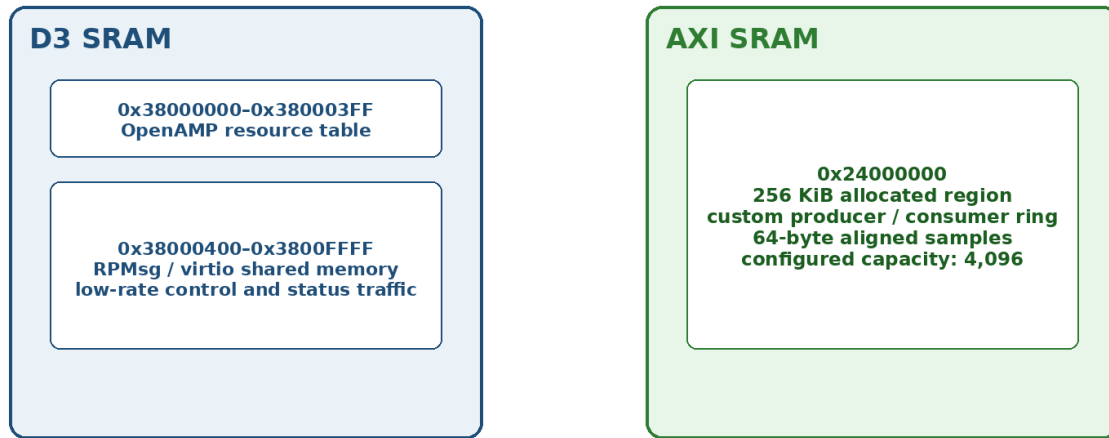
Figure 2. Dual-core architecture with physically separated control-message and shared-ring paths.

Interface	Verified role	Representative parameter
OpenAMP / RPMsg	Low-rate command and status coordination	44-byte application message
AXI-SRAM ring	High-rate aligned motion records	64-byte records; 4,096 nominal entries
M7 producer	Motion sequencing and sample publication	100 Hz sample production in the reviewed package
M4 consumer	Bounded service and accounting	Up to 128 records per service burst

3. Shared Memory, Timing, and Integrity

MotionIPC Shared-Memory Map

Separate regions preserve ST OpenAMP resources while providing a high-throughput custom data path



Engineering review finding: $4,096 \times 64$ -byte records plus metadata exceed the 256 KiB allocation by ~64 by

Figure 3. MotionIPC shared-memory allocation and the engineering review finding on nominal ring capacity.

- OpenAMP resources occupy D3 SRAM while the custom producer/consumer ring is allocated in AXI SRAM.
- Records are aligned to cache-line boundaries and include sequence, overflow, and heartbeat information.
- Engineering review identified that 4,096 records plus metadata exceed a 256 KiB allocation by approximately one record; release should use 4,095 entries or enlarge the reserved region.
- The target reports independent heartbeat and fault state so host-side silence is distinguishable from target-side failure.

4. Host Application and Test Workflow

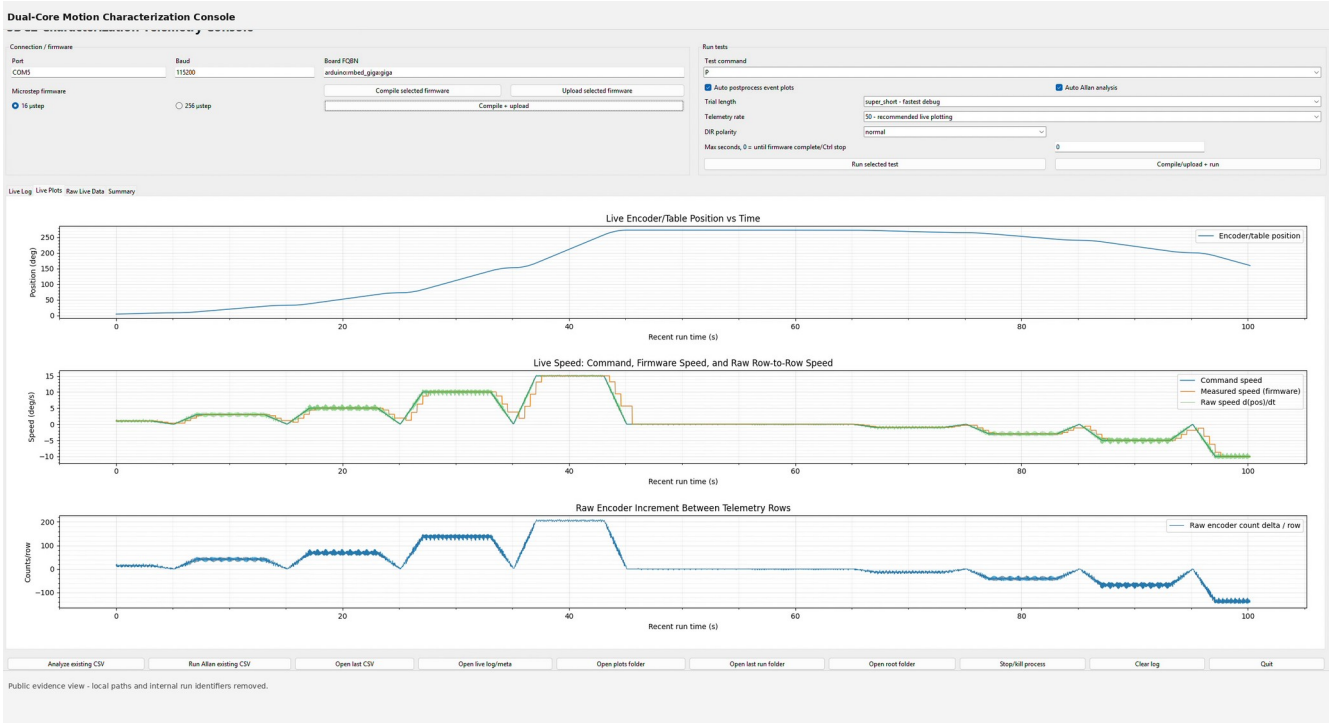


Figure 4. Host console view showing live position, commanded/measured speed, and raw encoder increments.

Workflow stage	Operator action	Recorded output
Connect	Select serial port and baud rate	Target identity and connection state
Configure	Select firmware and test definition	Run metadata and configuration
Execute	Start automated sequence	Live plots and telemetry rows
Review	Open generated outputs	CSV, figures, logs, and summary metrics

5. Low-Speed Tracking Results

SDC2 ONLY | 256 MICROSTEP BASELINE

Speed tracking summary: usable ultra-slow range, clear high-speed ceiling

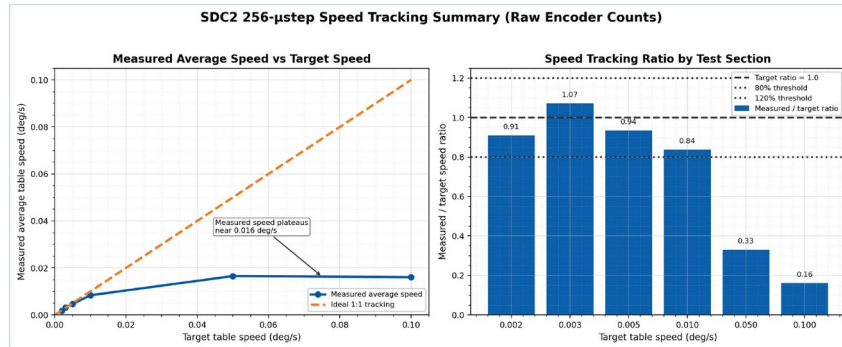


Figure 1. Clean summary view with legend moved off the data region. Average speed is computed from total raw encoder count delta over each section.

Main result

- 0.002-0.01 deg/s tracks in the correct range at the current 256 microstep setting.
- Best tracking occurs around 0.003-0.005 deg/s; 0.01 deg/s is usable but below target.
- 0.05 and 0.10 deg/s fail similarly and plateau near 0.016 deg/s actual speed.
- Interpretation: higher commanded speeds likely require lower microstepping and/or controller tuning.

Numerical baseline

- 0.002 -> 0.001818 deg/s, ratio 0.909
- 0.003 -> 0.003214 deg/s, ratio 1.071
- 0.005 -> 0.004676 deg/s, ratio 0.935
- 0.010 -> 0.008378 deg/s, ratio 0.838
- 0.050 -> 0.016560 deg/s, ratio 0.331
- 0.100 -> 0.016071 deg/s, ratio 0.161

SDC2 Encoder-Based Speed Tracking

Raw encoder-event analysis | no filtering or grouped averaging

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Figure 5. Speed-tracking summary showing the usable ultra-slow range and high-speed ceiling.

Commanded speed (deg/s)	Measured speed (deg/s)	Interpretation
0.002	0.001818	Trackable near the lower practical limit
0.003	0.003214	Best agreement region
0.005	0.004676	Strong low-speed tracking
0.010	0.008378	Usable with increasing bias
0.050-0.100	~0.016 plateau	Configuration-limited ceiling

6. Constant-Speed and Step-Response Characterization

Step-Response Transient Metrics: 16u vs 256u

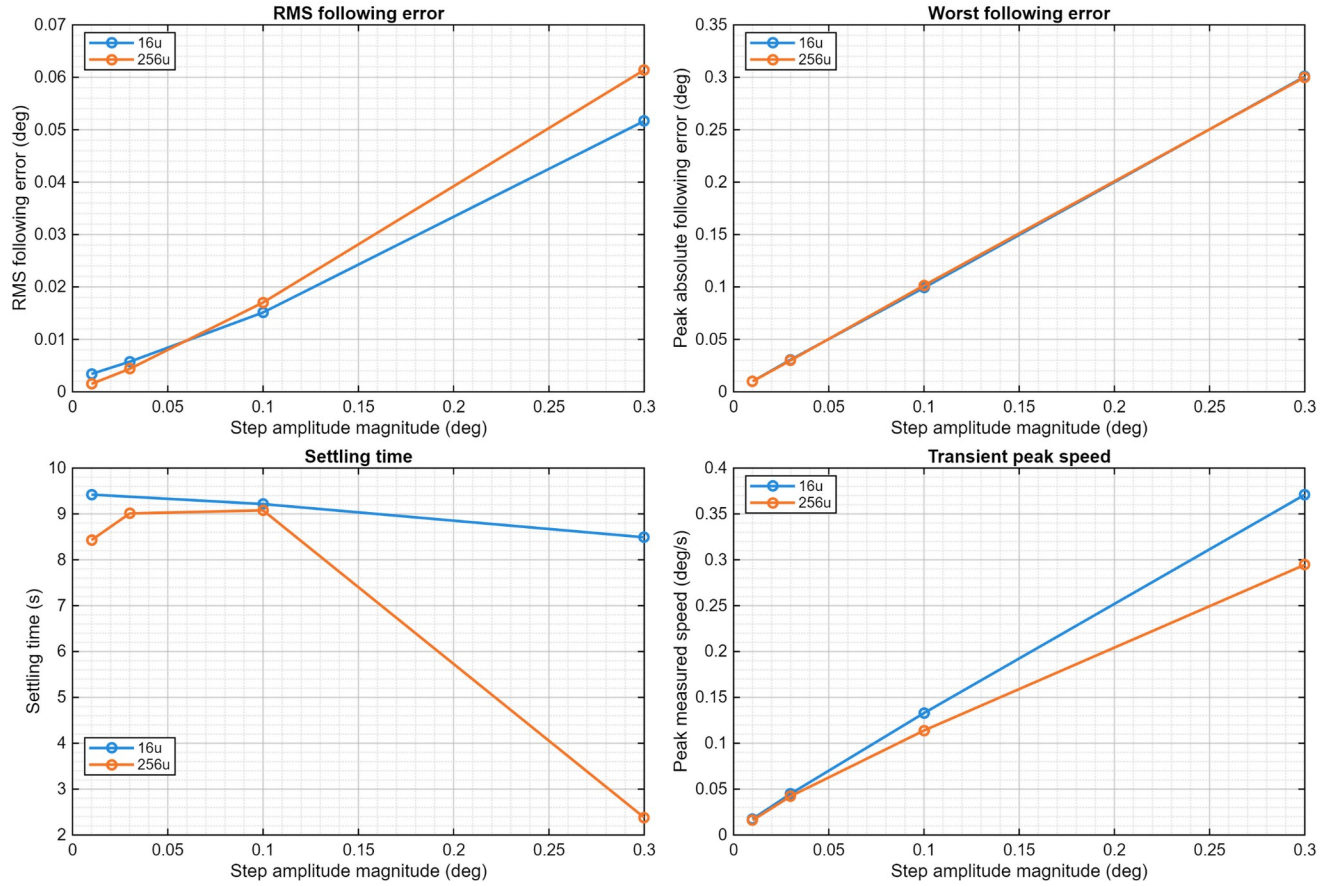


Figure 6. Extended constant-speed tracking and Allan-style stability summary.

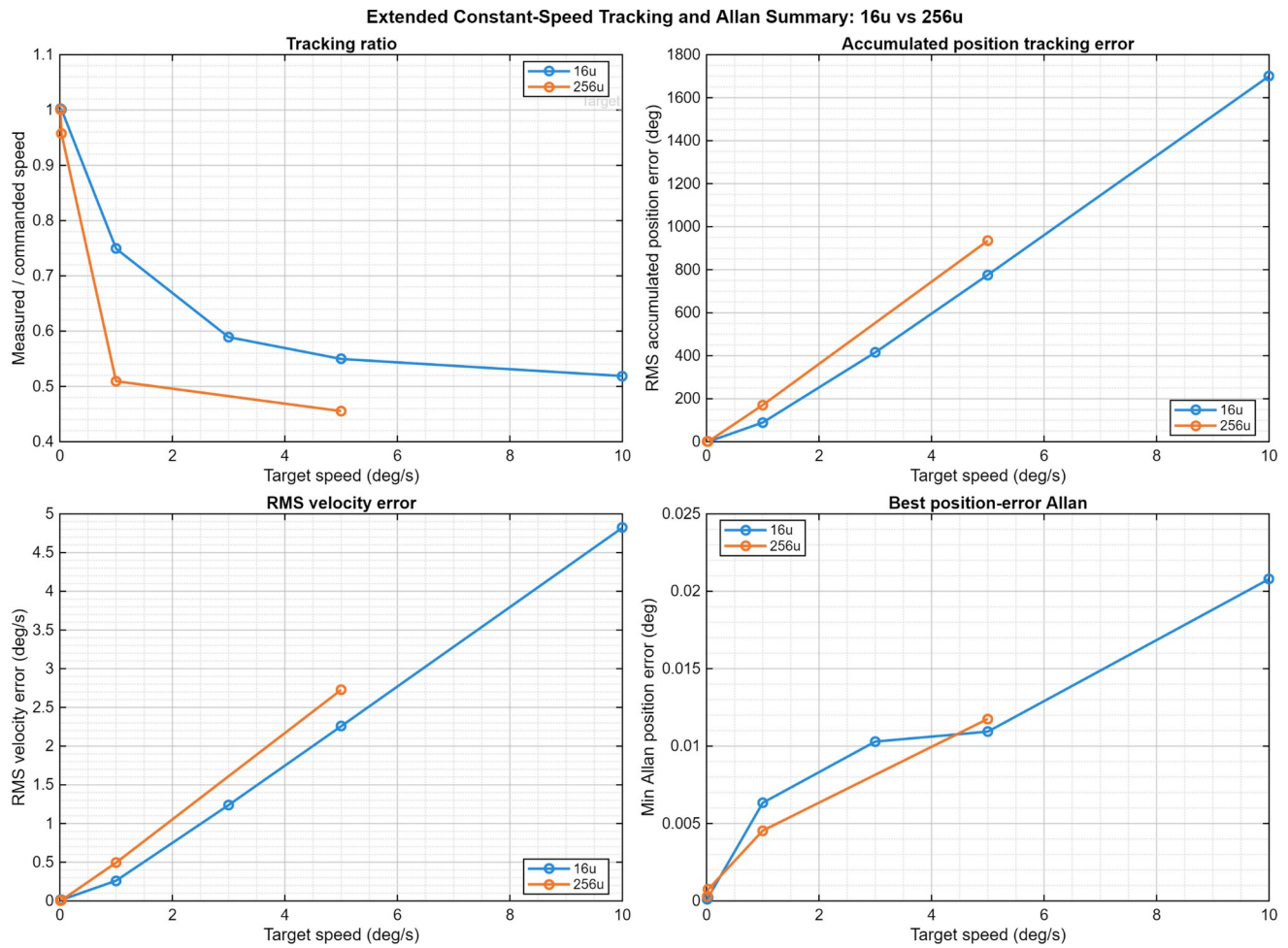


Figure 7. Step-response metrics for RMS following error, worst following error, gain, and position-area measures.

7. Closed-Loop Frequency Response

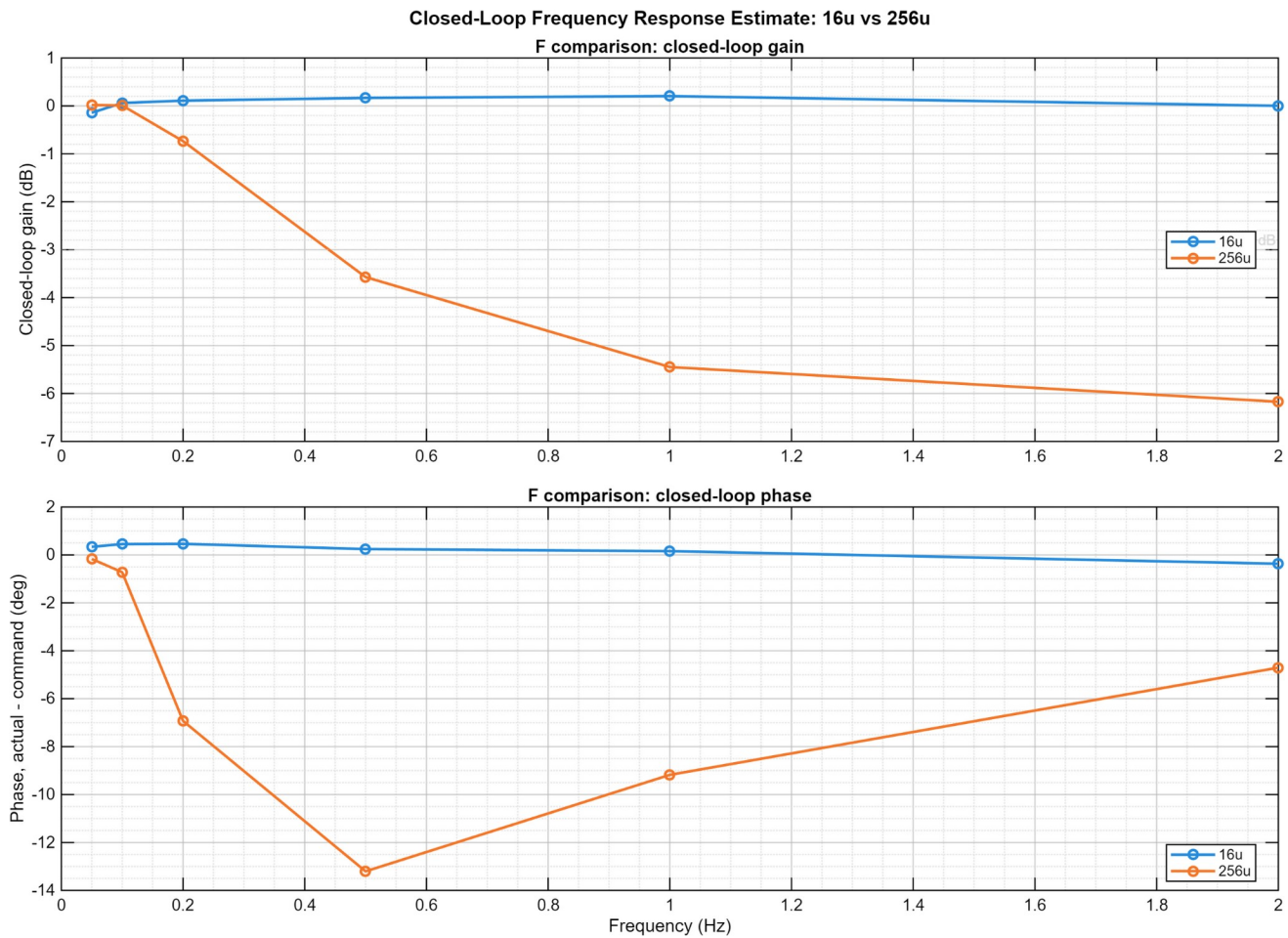


Figure 8. Closed-loop response estimate across the tested 0.33-2 Hz range.

The available evidence supports reporting response across the tested frequencies. It does not, by itself, establish a formal -3 dB bandwidth because the plotted data do not demonstrate a complete crossing with sufficient surrounding points.

8. Detailed Firmware and Host Design

The following parameters define the implemented timing model, inter-core transport, motion conversion, serial limits, safety behavior, and measured operating envelope. The primary architectural driver is the need to sustain higher STEP frequencies at the finest tested microstep setting without allowing host communication or telemetry work to disturb pulse timing.

Subsystem	Implemented detail	Engineering significance
Processor split	STM32H747 Cortex-M7 at 400 MHz and Cortex-M4 at 200 MHz, with pulse-critical control isolated from host-facing and telemetry service work.	Preserves timing margin and pulse spacing at the finest microstep setting as commanded speed and required STEP frequency increase.
Control messaging	OpenAMP/RPMsg; 44-byte application message with eight 32-bit payload words	Low-rate commands and status remain distinct from high-rate motion records.
High-rate path	AXI-SRAM producer/consumer ring at 0x24000000; 64-byte records aligned to 32-byte cache lines	Supports deterministic bulk transfer with sequence and overflow observability.
Resource table	OpenAMP shared resources in D3 SRAM beginning at 0x38000400	Keeps RPMsg resources separate from the custom motion-data ring.
Service behavior	M4 consumes bounded bursts of up to 128 records per pass	Prevents unbounded ring service from starving other work.
Health reporting	Independent heartbeats, fault state, sequence-gap, dropped-record, and ring-status counters	Allows the host to distinguish silence, backlog, overflow, and target faults.

8.1 Motion Timing and Safety Parameters

Parameter	Value	Notes
Serial link	115,200 baud	Full 24-field ASCII rows make 100 Hz a configured option, not a guaranteed sustained rate.
Telemetry selections	10, 20, 50, or 100 Hz; clamped 1-100 Hz	Practical sustained rate depends on row length and host/target overhead.
STEP pulse high time	4 microseconds	Explicit pulse-width control for the stepper driver interface.
Maximum step rate	25,000 pulses/s	Hard safety ceiling; equivalent to approximately 7.13 deg/s with the documented drivetrain.
Backlog limit	25 pulses emitted per loop	Bounds catch-up behavior after temporary host or loop delay.
Overrun warning	25 ms	Flags excessive loop latency.
Host heartbeat	500 ms	Periodic host liveness message.
Target deadman	2 s	Stops or faults commanded operation when host supervision is lost.
Speed estimate window	500 ms	Reduces encoder quantization noise in ultra-low-speed operation.

8.2 Drivetrain and Encoder Conversion

Quantity	Calculation / value	Interpretation
Motor steps	200 full steps/rev x 256 microsteps	51,200 pulses per motor revolution.

Quantity	Calculation / value	Interpretation
Gear ratio	24.65:1	Produces 1,262,080 pulses per table revolution.
Command resolution	3,505.78 pulses/degree	Approximately 0.000285 degree per command pulse.
Encoder decoding	5,000 CPR, A-channel CHANGE x2	10,000 motor-shaft counts/rev.
Table encoder scale	246,500 counts/rev	684.72 counts/degree, approximately 0.001460 degree/count.
Correction gain	20 pulse-Hz/degree	Closed-loop correction term applied to feedforward command.
Correction limits	250 Hz absolute and 5% of feedforward relative	Prevents the correction term from dominating commanded motion.

8.3 Measured Operating Results

Commanded speed	Measured speed	Observation
0.002 deg/s	0.001818 deg/s	Lower edge of demonstrated ultra-slow tracking.
0.003 deg/s	0.003214 deg/s	Best tracking region begins.
0.005 deg/s	0.004676 deg/s	Strong agreement in the preferred low-speed range.
0.010 deg/s	0.008378 deg/s	Tracking remains usable but error grows.
0.050-0.100 deg/s	approximately 0.016 deg/s plateau	Observed ceiling in the tested 256-microstep configuration.
Sine tests	0.33, 0.5, 1, and 2 Hz	Supports response reporting over the tested range, not a formal -3 dB bandwidth claim.

8.4 Host Workflow and Data Products

- The host application provides connection setup, command entry, scripted run selection, live position and speed plots, raw encoder-increment visibility, CSV logging, metadata capture, and post-run analysis launch points.
- Each run preserves command values, measured telemetry, timing, run identity, and analysis context so plots can be traced back to the source recording rather than treated as disconnected screenshots.
- Automated characterization covers low-speed sweeps, constant-speed tracking, step response, and closed-loop sine-response tests; safety and heartbeat state remain visible during those operations.

9. Safety, Reliability, and Release Controls

Control	Implemented behavior	Release consideration
Host heartbeat	Periodic host presence message	Target deadman should remain enabled
Pulse-rate cap	25,000 pulses/s maximum	Verify against final drivetrain and driver
Backlog bound	Maximum 25 pulses emitted per loop	Prevents unlimited catch-up bursts
Telemetry limits	Selectable 10/20/50/100 Hz	Full ASCII rows may constrain sustainable rate
Fault accounting	Sequence gaps, drops, heartbeat, fault counters	Expose in final operator status panel

At 115,200 baud, full 24-field ASCII telemetry rows cannot be assumed to sustain 100 Hz under all conditions. The configured option should be treated separately from demonstrated end-to-end serial throughput; 50-60 Hz is a more realistic full-row operating range without a binary protocol or higher link rate.

Requirements Verification and Traceability

The matrix below links each requirement to objective evidence and a current disposition. “Demonstrated” means evidence is present in this report or its cited source package; “Release action” means the requirement remains to be completed or formally witnessed before a controlled production release.

Requirement	Evidence / verification artifact	Disposition
FW-FR-001	Figures 2-3; IPC source review	Demonstrated
FW-FR-002	Shared-memory map; integrity counters	Demonstrated with ring-capacity correction action
FW-FR-003	Figure 1 and Figure 4 GUI evidence	Demonstrated
FW-FR-004	Figures 5-8 and scripted workflow	Demonstrated
FW-FR-005	CSV/metadata workflow description	Demonstrated
FW-FR-006	25 kHz cap, 4 us high time, backlog bound	Demonstrated by source review
FW-FR-007	Heartbeat/fault/sequence/drop state	Demonstrated; formal fault-injection witness recommended
FW-FR-008	Stop/deadman behavior	Implemented; formal acceptance witness recommended
FW-NFR-001 to 006	Detailed design tables and result limitations	Mixed: demonstrated and controlled limitations

Acceptance and Release Criteria

- A tagged target and host revision can execute the defined automated tests without an uncontrolled stop or pulse burst.
- Commanded and measured state remain visible, and the resulting CSV plus metadata can be traced to the run configuration.
- Heartbeat loss, sequence gaps, dropped records, and target faults are observable and produce the documented response.
- The shared-ring capacity correction is implemented or the reserved region is enlarged before controlled release.
- Claims remain limited to the demonstrated operating range and test evidence.

10. Limitations and Document Control

Item	Controlled statement
Prototype maturity	No formal shock, vibration, thermal, EMC, or long-duration certification is claimed.
MotionIPC package	The reviewed v0.1 sample producer runs at 100 Hz and 6.4 kB/s. This validates the transport path but does not represent the reason for the dual-core split; the design driver is higher STEP-frequency headroom and pulse regularity at 256 microsteps.
Bandwidth claim	Tested response is reported; formal bandwidth is not claimed.

Item	Controlled statement
Release package	Preserve tagged source, host build, test definitions, and representative datasets together.

Attribution

Herder Elektronische Systemen developed the public-facing engineering package and documents the dual-core firmware integration, host software, test workflows, and measured evidence represented here. No third-party affiliation or endorsement is claimed.

Revision record

Revision	Date	Description
5.0	2026-08-05	Reframed as a controlled FRD with explicit functional requirements, interfaces, acceptance criteria, traceability, while preserving GUI, architecture, and measured-result imagery; removed inherited layout defects and preserved evidence boundaries.
5.2	2026-08-05	Corrected the dual-core trade-off rationale: the architecture was selected to preserve smooth higher-speed motion at the 256-microstep setting by isolating pulse-critical control from variable-latency communication and telemetry work. Clarified that 100 Hz, 6.4 kB/s telemetry is not the performance justification.

Configuration, Interfaces, and Reproducible Test Setup

This section records the controller-side interfaces and operating conditions needed to reproduce the firmware and host-software tests. Full driver switch settings, physical wiring, and electrical implementation remain controlled by the companion platform/electrical FRD.

Target I/O and Implemented Signal Use

Conn.	Signal	Board pin	MCU pin	Status	Firmware-facing definition
1	Encoder A	D2	PA3	Active	Quadrature channel A from differential receiver
2	Encoder B	D3	PA2	Active	Quadrature channel B from differential receiver
3	STEP	D10	PK1	Active	Pulse output through transistor interface to R725 STEP input
4	DIR	D13	PH6	Active	Direction output through transistor interface to R725 DIR input
5	Encoder Z / Index	D4	PJ8	Wired; unused	Physically present but not consumed by the current firmware
6	+5 V	5V	-	Power	Interface logic rail
7	Ground	GND	-	Power	Common logic/interface reference

The encoder index channel is intentionally documented as wired but unused. Enabling index-based homing requires an explicit firmware change, input configuration, and validation of the resulting reference behavior; it is not implied by the current implementation.

Driver Configuration Assumption

Measured low-speed characterization used the 256-microstep driver configuration. The firmware converts commanded angular speed into pulse frequency using the configured microstep count and 24.65:1 gearbox. The authoritative DIP-switch table is provided in the platform/electrical FRD and repository configuration file.

Parameter	Value used in analysis	Software consequence
Motor full steps	200 steps/rev	Base motor resolution
Microstep setting	256 microsteps/full step	51,200 pulses/motor revolution
Gear ratio	24.65:1	1,262,080 pulses/table revolution
Pulse scale	3,505.78 pulses/degree	Command-to-pulse conversion
Encoder CPR	5,000 CPR; A/B CHANGE decoding	10,000 motor counts/revolution
Table encoder scale	246,500 counts/table revolution	684.72 counts/degree

Driver Timing and Logic Constraints

- STEP pulse-high time is 4 microseconds in the characterized firmware.
- The software pulse-rate safety ceiling is 25,000 pulses per second.
- The current implementation limits catch-up emission to 25 pulses per main-loop pass.
- An overrun warning is generated when loop delay exceeds 25 ms.
- R725 supply-voltage, current, and logic-input requirements are hardware constraints and are defined in the platform/electrical FRD.

Repeatable Host and Target Test Procedure

Step	Action	Acceptance / retained evidence
1	Inspect hardware configuration	Confirm 256-microstep setting, connector seating, encoder wiring, E-stop access, and unobstructed stage travel.
2	Apply power	Power the controller/interface logic and motor driver using the documented hardware sequence; verify no unexpected motion.
3	Connect host	Select the correct serial port, use 115,200 baud, and establish the GUI connection.
4	Establish reference	Confirm encoder position and direction sense; set or record the test origin.
5	Select test	Choose constant-speed, step-response, or frequency-response sequence and record configuration metadata.
6	Run and monitor	Observe commanded speed, measured speed, encoder position, heartbeat, dropped-record, and fault indicators.
7	Retain evidence	Save CSV, metadata, plot outputs, firmware revision, and test notes.
8	Safe shutdown	Command zero speed, confirm motion has stopped, disconnect host session, and isolate motor power before service.

Software Safety and Fault Response

Condition	Required software response	Verification evidence
Host heartbeat absent for 2 s	Enter safe zero-command state and report timeout	Disconnect or suppress heartbeat during controlled bench test
Invalid or out-of-range command	Reject or clamp command and retain prior safe state	Boundary-command test and log review
Sequence gap / dropped record	Increment diagnostic count without silently presenting contiguous data	Injected or observed ring-gap test
Loop overrun >25 ms	Raise diagnostic warning and retain traceability	Timed-stall or instrumentation test
Communication restart	Recover without uncontrolled motion	Disconnect/reconnect test with zero-command precondition

Firmware Acceptance Tests

ID	Acceptance criterion	Method
FW-AT-01	Host connects at 115,200 baud and receives parseable telemetry	Demonstration and log inspection
FW-AT-02	Commanded direction agrees with measured encoder direction	Positive/negative low-speed test
FW-AT-03	CSV and metadata outputs are created for an automated sequence	Run-script inspection
FW-AT-04	Heartbeat timeout produces a safe zero-command state	Controlled heartbeat-loss test
FW-AT-05	Sequence-gap and dropped-record counters remain visible and auditable	Diagnostic field inspection
FW-AT-06	Representative low-speed results reproduce the documented order of magnitude	Repeat selected 0.002-0.010 deg/s points